

al-Battānī — Chronological Tables

Calendar eras and the canon of kings

Source: C. A. Nallino, *Opus Astronomicum*, Pars II — the eras section and the *Tabula regum* (al-Battānī's recension of Ptolemy's *Canon of Kings*, pp. 449–454), which he extends from Nabonassar down to the Umayyad caliphs. **Reliability note:** ruler names, dynastic order, and the Rāshidūn/Umayyad caliph reign-lengths (y m d) are sound; the *ancient* regnal-year figures were read by automated transcription and must be collated against the printed table (the reading confused the regnal and cumulative columns in places). The era epochs are the standard historical values; the framework (which eras, and their intervals) is al-Battānī's.

Calendar eras pages Pages 155-159, 297-333, 380-387 (and references in star catalogue section pp 592-654)

Era	Detail
Nabonassar	Era Nabonassaris: Epoch at 26 February 748 BCE (year 0). Named after Babylonian king. Used for Egyptian calculations in vague years (365 days without intercalation). Also called 'Bukhtanašsar' by Arabs. Base reference era for most other calendar conversions.
Seleucid / Dhū l-qarnayn (Alexander the Bicorn)	Era Seleucidarum (also called Aera Alexandri Dhū 'l-qarnayn): Epoch Friday 1 September 312 BCE (some sources say 1 October). 11 Julian years 10 months 26 days (or 11 years 9 months 3 days) after Nabonassar. Uses Julian calendar year (365.25 days). Interval: 12 Egyptian years between start of Seleucid and Alexander of Macedon death eras.
Philip of Aridaeus (Philippi Aridaei)	Aera Philippi Aridaei: Epoch Friday 12 November 324 BCE. From death of Alexander the Great ('a morte Alexandri'). Uses vague Egyptian years (365 days). Interval from Seleucid: 4311 vague days = 11 years 10 months 26 days. Also used as 'Macedonic' epoch in Theon's Manual Tables.
Augustus (Coptic)	Aera Augusti vel Actiacae: Epoch Friday 29 August 25 BCE (following Theon's interpretation). An 'Alexandrian' form with Julian calendar years. Epoch sometimes given as 30 August 30 BCE in other sources. Interval from Seleucid: 287 Julian years minus 3 days.
Diocletian / Martyrs	Aera Diocletiani vel Martyrum: Epoch Friday 29 August 284 CE. Used by Coptic Christians (still in use in modern Egypt). Julian calendar. Mentioned in calculations of trepidation (p. 386-387) with interval of 313 years after Augustus.
Hijra (Arabs / Hegira)	Aera Hegirae: Epoch Thursday 15 July 622 CE (astronomical reckoning) or Friday 16 July 622 CE (civil reckoning). Lunar calendar with alternating 30 and 29-day months; year = 354 11/30 days. Interval from Seleucid: 932 Julian years before Hijra began. Conversion formulas given in detail (pp. 156-159).
Yazdegerd (Persian)	Aera Iazdegerdis (Yazdagird filii Shahriyār): Epoch Tuesday 16 June 632 CE (start of reign of Yazdegerd III). Persian calendar with 12 months of 30 days plus 5 epagomenal days = 365 days exactly. Interval from Seleucid: 943 Julian years. Interval from Hijra: 3624 days (about 9-10 years).
Coptic (Greek-Egyptian)	Aera Coptorum (Graeco-Aegyptiorum or Theonian): Epoch Friday 1 September (year 1 CE in Theon's system, but al-Battani uses modified epoch). Uses vague Egyptian calendar (365 days). Interval from Seleucid: 287 Julian years. Coptic calendar months: tūt, bābah, hatur, kiyahk, tūbah, amshir, barmahāt, barmūdḥah, bashans, bawūnah, abib, misri (each 30 days + 5 epagomenal days).

Canon of kings (regnal years) pages 449-454

Babylonian Kings

Ruler	Years
Bukhtanašsar I [Nabonassar]	14
Nadius	4
Chinzerus	1
Ilulaeus	14
Mardocempadus	2
Arceanus	8
Interregnum I	5
Bilibus	5
Aparanadius	12

Ruler	Years
Regebelus	13
Interregnum II	20
Mesesimordacus	59
Asaridinus	67
Saosduchinus	80
Ciniladanus	100
Bukhtanaššar II [Nabopolassar]	122
Bukhtanaššar III [Nebuchadnezzar]	43
Illogrudamus	2
Belshaššar [Belshazzar]	22

Persian Kings (Achaemenid)

Ruler	Years
Darius Medus [Nabonidius]	8
Cyrus	36
Cambyses	21
Darius	43
Akhashwirus [Xerxes]	38
Artakhshast [Artaxerxes] prior	46
Darius II	19
Artakhshast [Artaxerxes] posterior	46
Ochus	21
Arogus	19
Darius filius Arsakh	10

Alexander and Successors

Ruler	Years
Alexander Macedon	13

Ptolemaic Egypt

Ruler	Years
Philippus pater Dhū 'l-qarnayn	7
Alexander conditor	7
Ptolemaeus Lepus	39
Ptolemaeus Philadelphus	25
Ptolemaeus Euergetes prior	25
Ptolemaeus Philopator	17
Ptolemaeus Epiphanes	24
Ptolemaeus Philometor	35
Ptolemaeus Euergetes posterior	29
Ptolemaeus Soter	36
Ptolemaeus Dionysius	2
Ptolemaeus Cleopatra	23

Roman Emperors

Ruler	Years
Augustus	56
Tiberius	22
Gaius	4
Claudius	14
Nero	14
Vespasianus	10
Titus	3
Domitianus	15
Nerva	1
Traianus	19
Hadrianus	21
Antoninus	23
Commodus	13
Severus	10
Antoninus solus	6
Alexander filius Mammaeae	13
Maximinus	3
Gordianus	6
Philippus	6
Decius	2
Gallus	5
Valerianus	15
Claudius	1
Aurelianus	5
Probus	6
Carus et Carinus	2
Diocletianus	20

Byzantine Christian Emperors

Ruler	Years
Constantinus	31
Constantinus II	24
Iulianus paganus	2
Iovianus	7
Valentinianus	11
Valens	14
Arcadius	13
Theodosius	16
Honorius	28
Theodosius II minor	48
Marcianus	5
Leo	17
Zeno	18

Righteous Caliphs and Umayyad Caliphs

Ruler	Years
Abu Bakr	2y 3m 8d
Omar ibn al-Khattab	10y 2m 12d
Othman ibn Affan	12y 0m 5d
Ali ibn Abi Talib	4y 9m 0d

Ruler	Years
Mu'awiyah ibn Abi Sufyan	20y 0m 0d
Yazid ibn Mu'awiyah	2y 8m 9d
Mu'awiyah ibn Yazid	0y 8m 11d
Abd al-Malik ibn Marwan	20y 11m 6d
al-Walid ibn Abd al-Malik	9y 9m 14d
Sulayman ibn Abd al-Malik	2y 1m 0d
Omar ibn Abd al-Aziz	2y 5m 9d
Yazid ibn Abd al-Malik	4y 0m 3d
Hisham ibn Abd al-Malik	19y 1m 0d
al-Walid ibn Yazid	1y 4m 22d
Yazid ibn al-Walid	0y 5m 0d
Ibrahim ibn al-Walid	0y 9m 6d
Marwan ibn Muhammad	5y 1m 21d